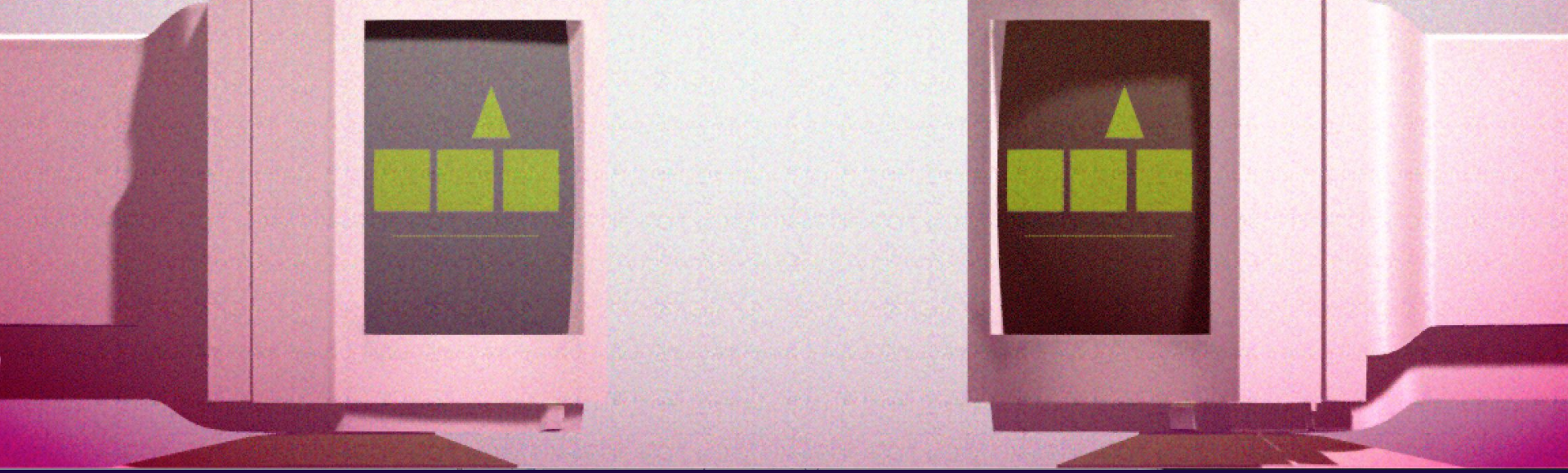
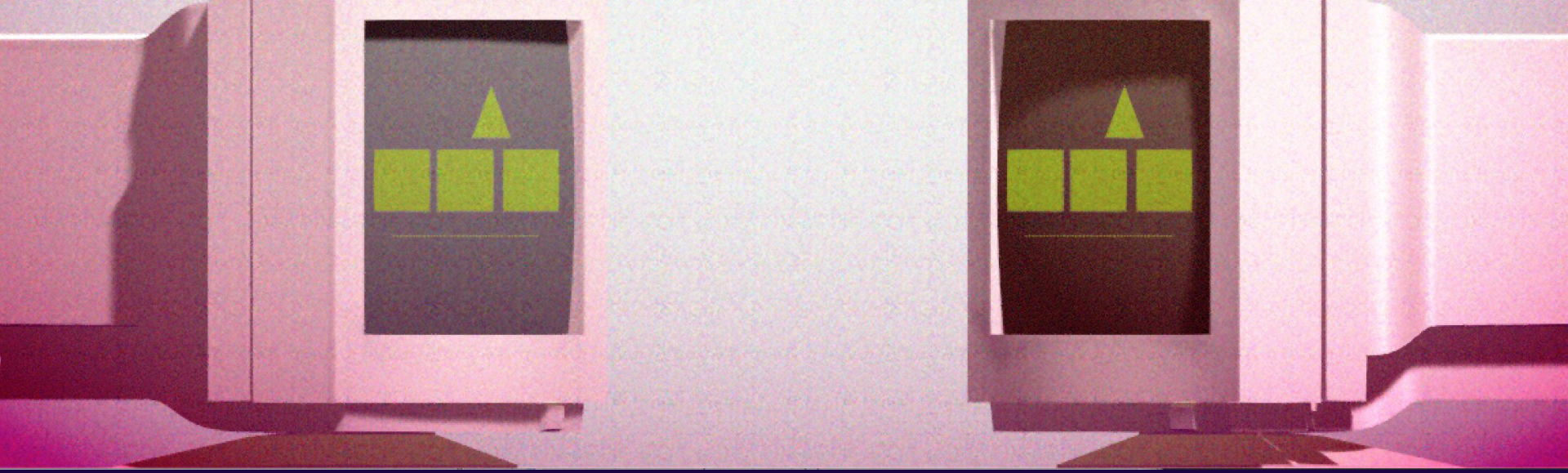
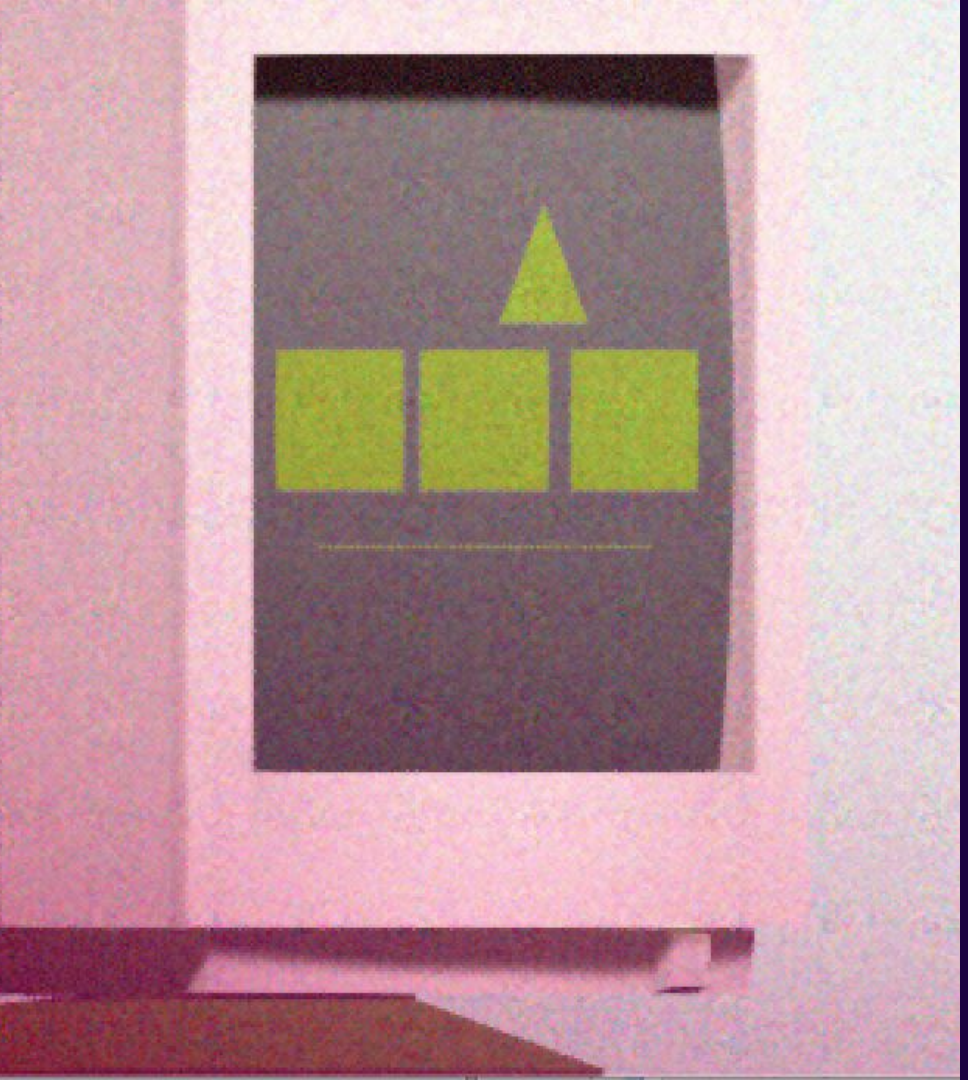


SARAH ROTHBERG

TALK PREPARED FOR
ARTIST COMMONS 2026



HOW DO NEW COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGIES IMPACT OUR SENSE OF SELF, OUR CONNECTION TO EACH OTHER AND TO THE WORLD?



KEY WORDS:

POETIC, HUMOROUS, CONCEPTUAL, SYSTEMS, INVITATIONAL

THEMES:

CONVERSATION, WORLDS, REAL-TIME, TECHNOLOGY AND MEMORY/COGNITION, SOCIAL IMPACT OF MEDIATION, CHANGE THROUGH IMAGINATION

FORMS:

SOFTWARE

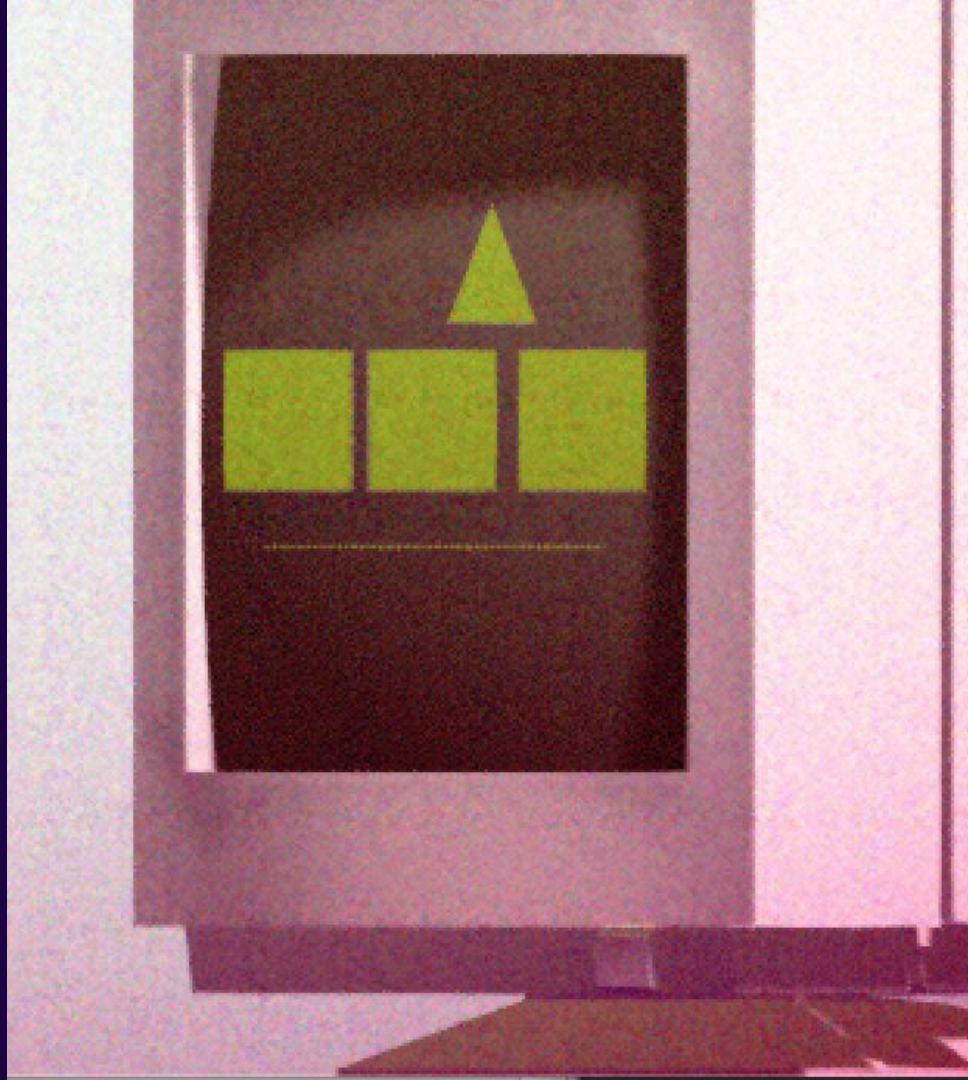
PERFORMANCE

INSTALLATION

WORKSHOPS/EXPERIENCES

WRITING

EXPERIMENTS WITH NEW TECHNOLOGIES

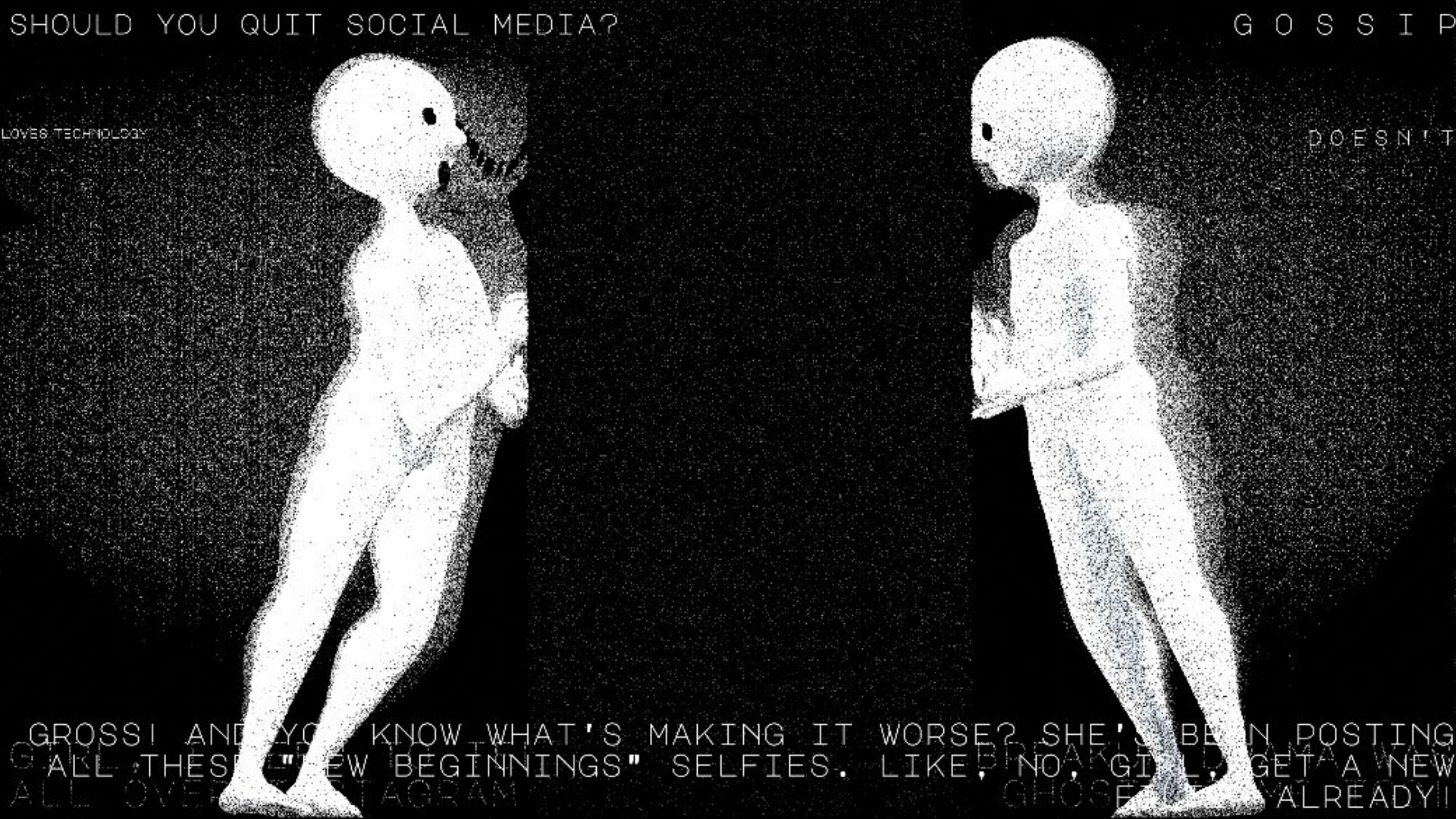


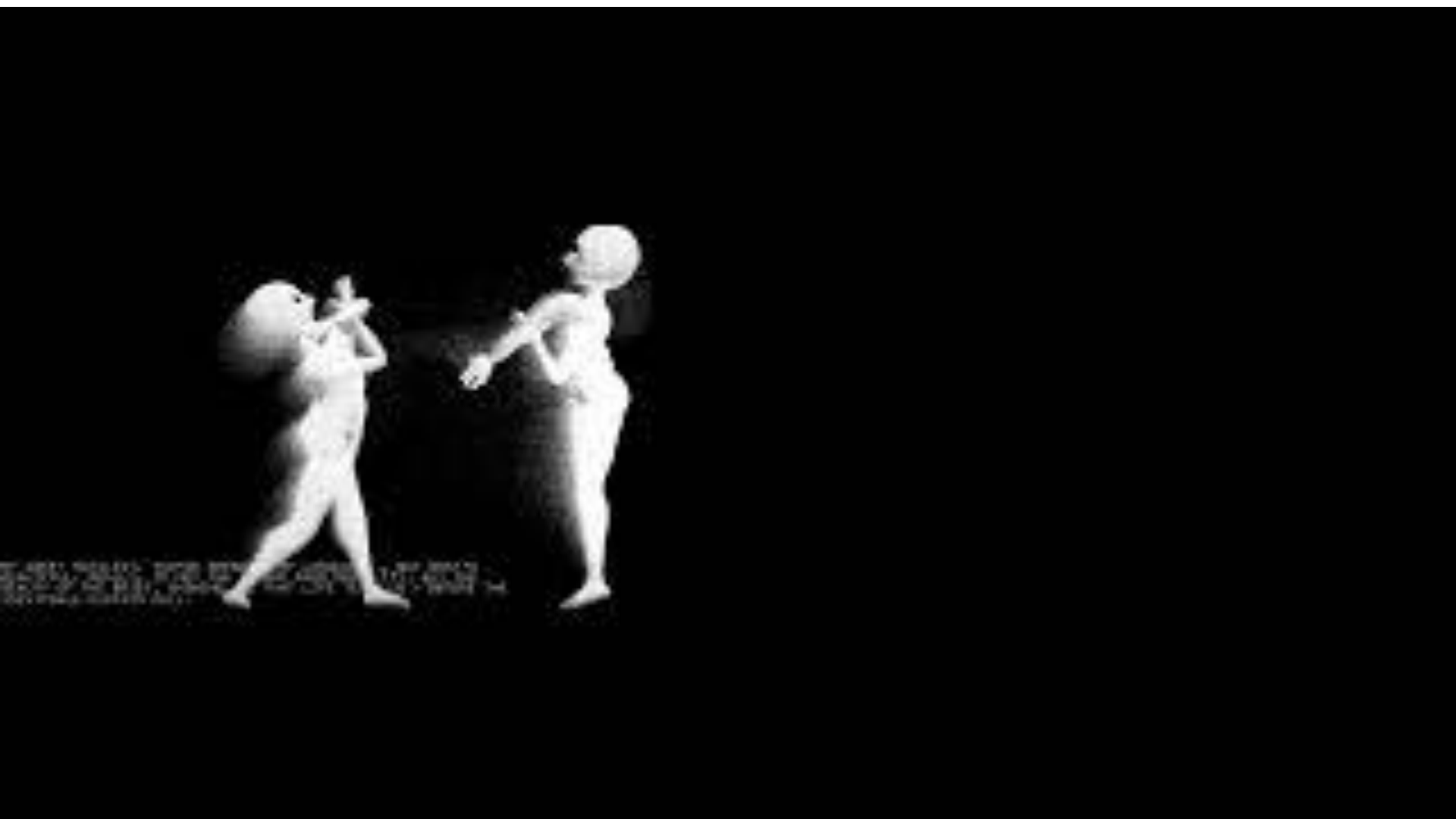
A FEW RANDOM HIGHLIGHTS, TO ANCHOR YOU!

FOREVER MEETINGS (2025/6)

IS IT POSSIBLE TO CHANGE?
EARNEST
APOLOGY
POSSIBLE
HANGE? IS IT POSS
I'M SORRY IF I CAME ACROSS INSENSITIVE... MY
SISTER-IN-LAW FROZE EGGS AT 38 AND NOW SHE'S
PREGNANT... MAYBE I WAS WRONG ABOUT THE TIMING?

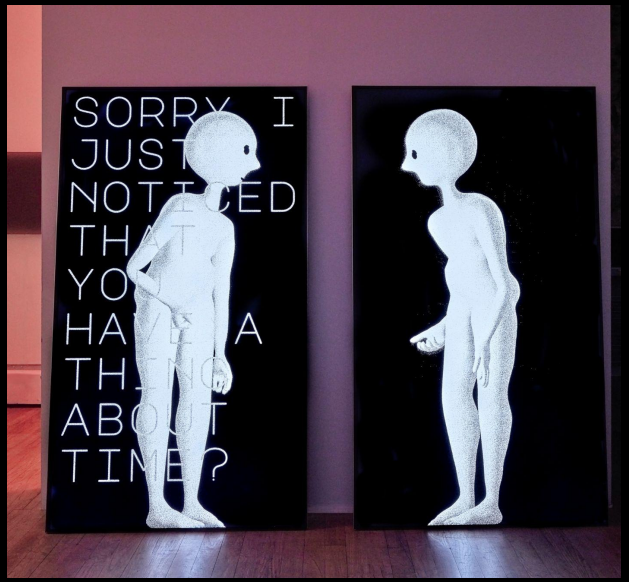
SELFISH
DO MY ACTIONS MATTER?
MY ACTIONS MA ER?
NEGOTIATION
DO MY ACTION
YOU KNOW AS WELL AS I DO, IT'S CORPORATE
PROFITS, THE FAT CATS AT THE TOP ARE WHAT DRIVE
INNOVATION.


SHOULD YOU QUIT SOCIAL MEDIA?
LOVES TECHNOLOGY
G O S S I P
DOESN'T
GROSS! AND YOU KNOW WHAT'S MAKING IT WORSE? SHE'S BEEN POSTING
ALL THESE "NEW BEGINNINGS" SELFIES. LIKE, NO, GIRL, GET A NEW
ALREADY!



WHAT A PERSON SEEMS TO BE
SENSITIVE
DETACHED
DON'T INFLUENCE THE WAY OTHERS PERCEIVE

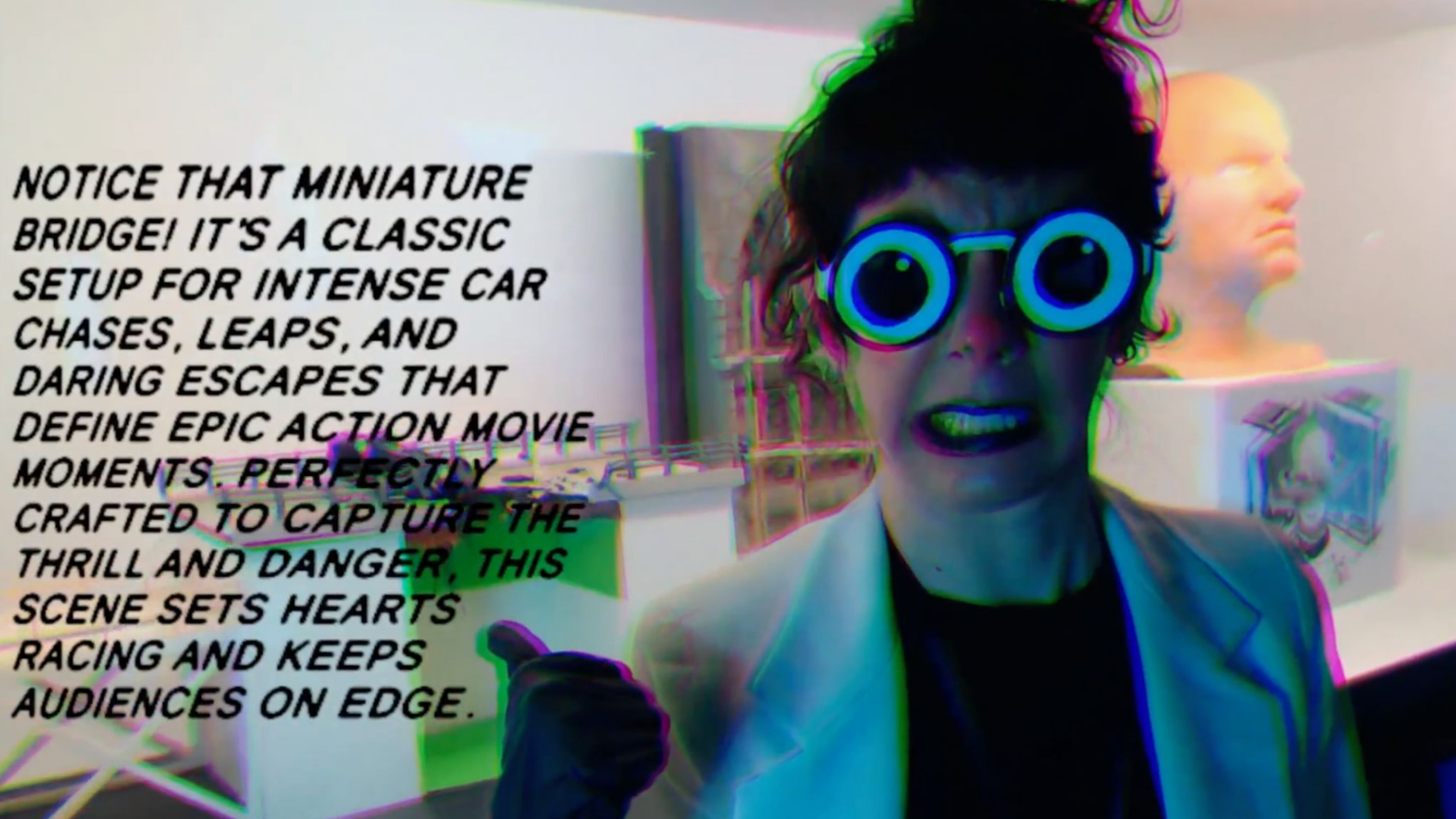
IN THE MARKET?
MACHISMO
MACHISTMOS
NIHILISTIC


SORRY I
JUST
NOT ICED
TH
YO
HA A
TH
AB T
TIM ?

HUMAN IN THE LOOP,
2024

Actor 0 Refresh
3 / 12
relax after the show."
"I actually saw a fantastic production of A Midsummer
Actor 2 Refresh
6 / 12
I use Trello boards and Pomodoro technique for coding productivity.
Actor 4 Refresh
3 / 12
"Yes, let's ignite the passion for justice!"
"Protest signs with powerful messages,
Actor 1 Refresh
3 / 12
relax after the show."
"I actually saw a fantastic production of A Midsummer
Actor 3 Refresh
6 / 12
I use Trello boards and Pomodoro technique for coding productivity.
Actor 5 Refresh
3 / 12
"Yes, let's ignite the passion for justice!"
"Protest signs with powerful messages,

EXPERT
GIVES A
TOUR
2025


NOTICE THAT MINIATURE BRIDGE! IT'S A CLASSIC SETUP FOR INTENSE CAR CHASES, LEAPS, AND DARING ESCAPES THAT DEFINE EPIC ACTION MOVIE MOMENTS. PERFECTLY CRAFTED TO CAPTURE THE THRILL AND DANGER, THIS SCENE SETS HEARTS RACING AND KEEPS AUDIENCES ON EDGE.

sarah is on

Portals
EXIT

EXPERT GIVES

SCROLL-O-METER

AR BIENNALE

DIGITAL SCULPTURE PARK DÜSSELDORF, ESSEN, COLOGNE

AUGUST 22 2021 – FEBRUARY 20 2022

+ + + AR-Biennale will be extended + + + the digital sculpture park can now be visited until April 24th + + +

COLLABORATIONS: MORE&MORE Unlimited

(with Marina Zurkow, since 2016)

WHAT IS
HAPPENING
BUTTERCUP

26-1-1-2
1. R Forest Hills-71 Av 2 min
4. R Forest Hills-71 Av 11 min
5:13 PM 74°F
Please stan
DeKalb Avenue
DeKalb Avenue
WHAT IS A MEMORY

WHAT IS A CONNECTION
A C E J Z R W 1 2 3 4 5

WORK
FOOD AV
INFORMATION &
LEARNING
MORE&MORE

GUIDE BOOK

HOW TO PLAY

Choose 1 card from 6 different categories. Flip them over all at the same time.

For a quick overview of basic play - watch this HOW TO PLAY video.

IMAGINE

Start to imagine a world based on your cards: if these cards are true, what else might be true? Try to imagine a world you *want* to live in.

INHABIT

Choose a role card, and imagine yourself as that role in your world. Make something from your world! A speech, diary entry, a song, a costume.

REFLECT

Share the story of your world. What sparks new ideas about the present? Discuss.

INFORMATION & LEARNING	PERSONAL COMMUNICATION	SHARED VALUES
INFORMATION IS SPREAD ON SKYWRITING & BLIMPS	NO ONE HAS A NAME	FLAMBOYANCE

WORK CONDITIONS	GOVERNMENT	LIVING CONDITIONS
YOUR JOB IS A SECRET	REDDIT-STYLE DEMOCRACY: UPVOTE & DOWNVOTES FOR ALL DECISIONS	EVERYONE ON THIS PLANET LIVES IN ONE BUILDING

CATEGORIES

- CLIMATE
- ECONOMIC SYSTEM
- FOOD AVAILABILITY
- GOVERNMENT
- HEALTH
- INFORMATION & LEARNING
- LIVING CONDITIONS
- PERSONAL COMMUNICATION

ROLE

RESTORE DISCARDED CARDS

SHUFFLE & RESET

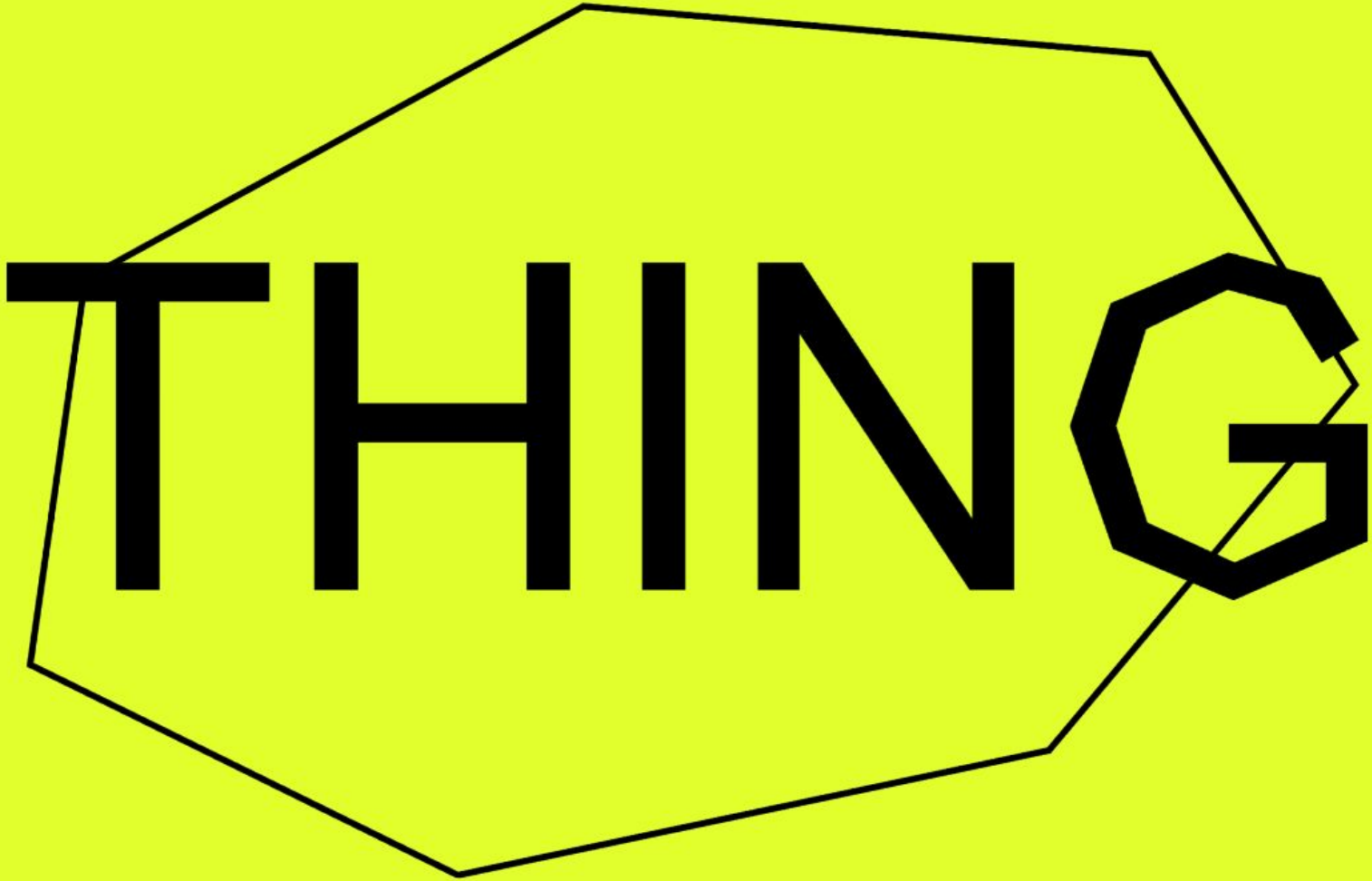
IMAGES FROM INSTALLATION/WORKSHOP AT MOMA WITH COLLABORATION : MOREANDMORE.WORLD

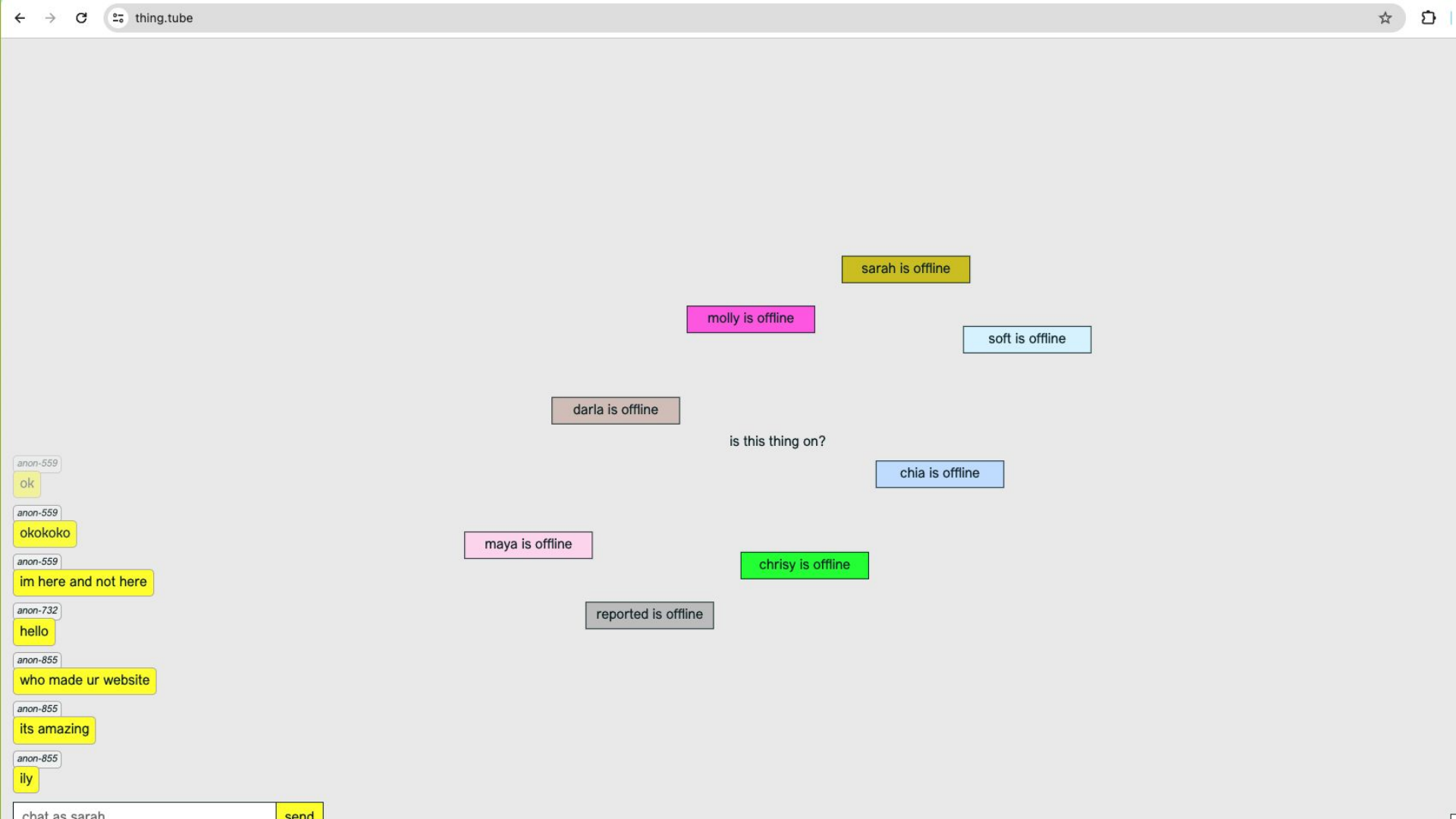
WHAT DO
YOU DO
ALL DAY?

STARCH
RUSH
LEGUME

COLLABORATIONS: IS THIS THING ON?

(with Christopher Clary, Molly Soda, Bhavik Singh, since 2022)


THING


thing.tube
sarah is offline
molly is offline
soft is offline
darla is offline
is this thing on?
chia is offline
maya is offline
chrisy is offline
reported is offline
anon-559
ok
anon-559
okokoko
anon-559
im here and not here
anon-732
hello
anon-855
who made ur website
anon-855
its amazing
anon-855
ily
chat as sarah
send

thing.tube

is this thing on?

hola

anon-977
hey hey

soft networks
hello!

soft networks
TESTING!!!!!!

soft networks
wowwwwww testing!!

soft networks
EVERYONE REFRESH YOUR CHATS PLEASE <3

anon-788
yyyyyyyyaay

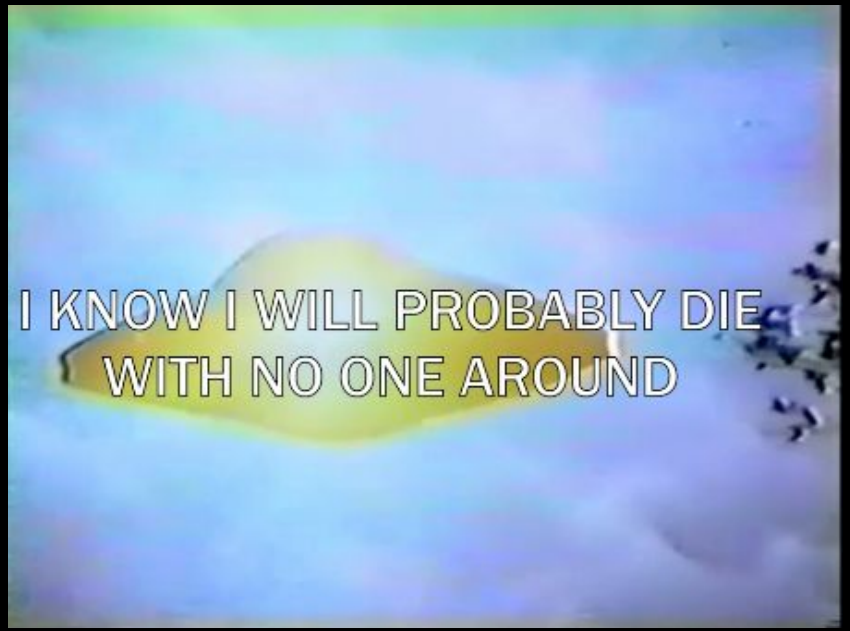
anon-426
disagree

chat as chrisy
send

about
chrisy

AMERICA
Online
Dialing...

POEMS
BY ME
AND
MY
PHONE


I KNOW I WILL PROBABLY DIE
WITH NO ONE AROUND

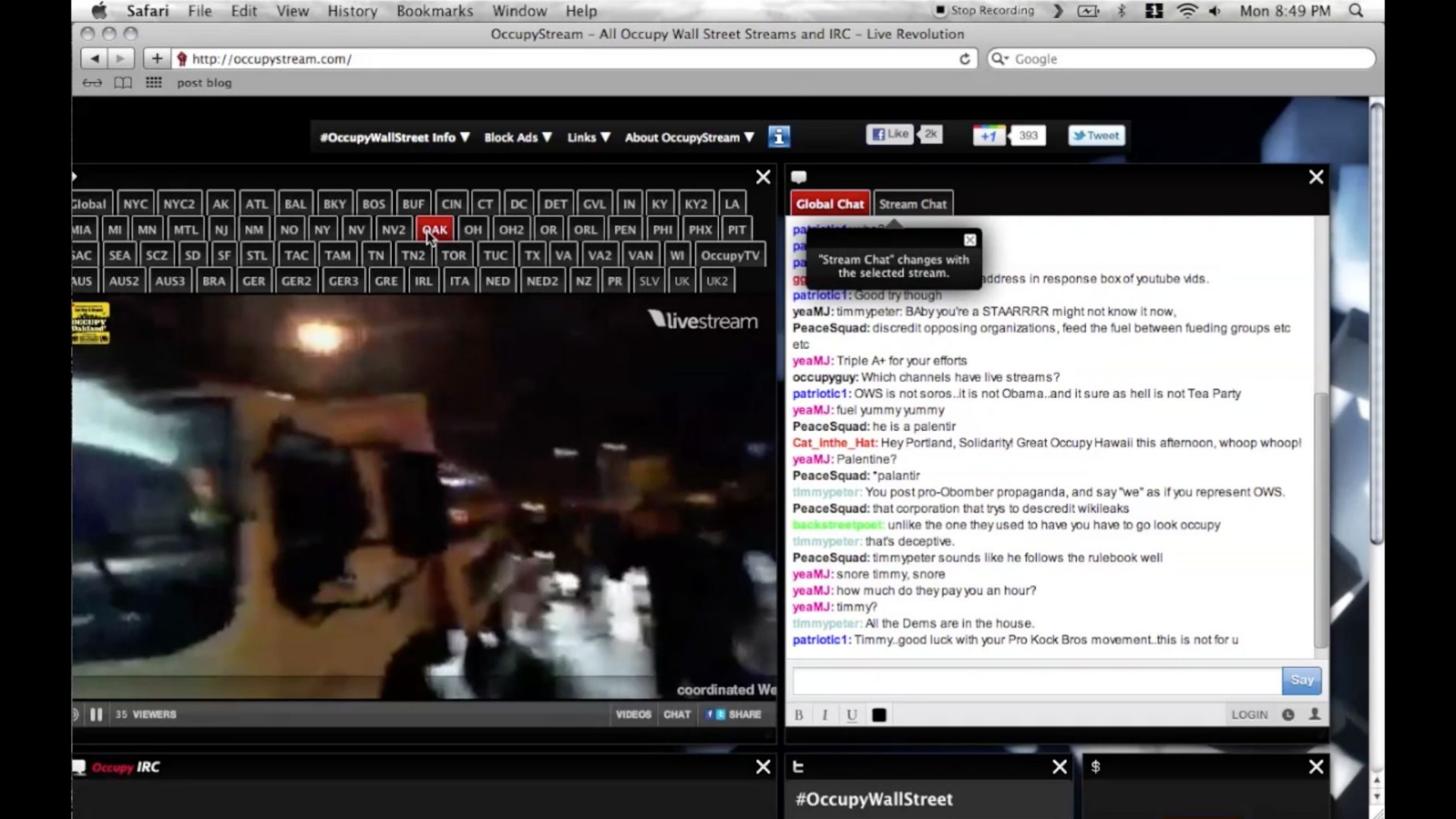
!

Busy December

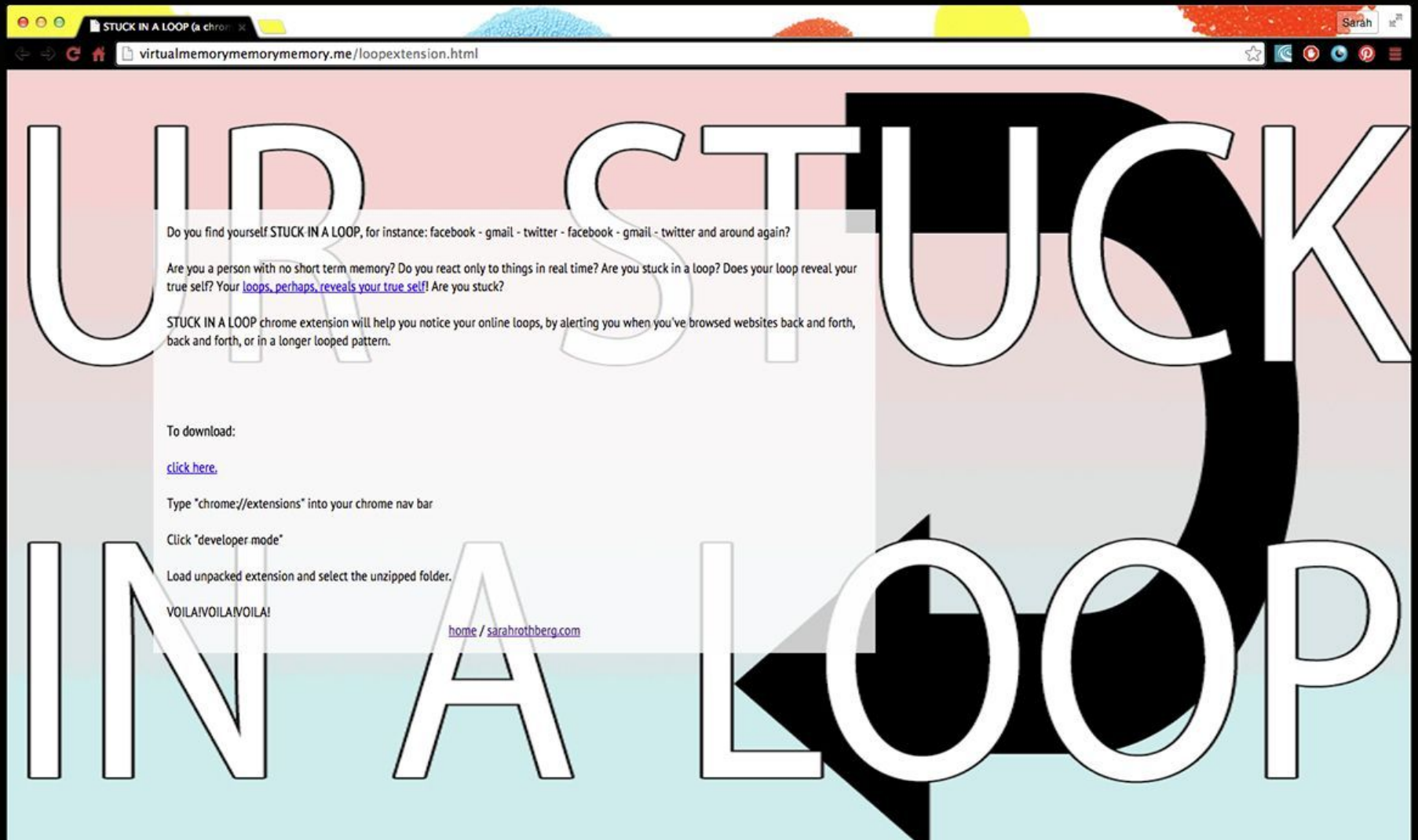
What's it mean to delete a part
What's it mean to ascribe meaning to actions

INCIDENTAL FOOTAGE, A FESTIVAL OF VIDEOS TAKEN BY MISTAKE

COLLABORATORS: KELSA TROM AND JILLIAN ROBERTS (LECTRIC COLLECTIVE)


Safari File Edit View History Bookmarks Window Help
Stop Recording
Mon 8:49 PM
OccupyStream – All Occupy Wall Street Streams and IRC – Live Revolution
http://occupystream.com/
Google
post blog
#OccupyWallStreet Info
Block Ads
Links
About OccupyStream
Like 2K
+1 393
Tweet
Global NYC NYC2 AK ATL BAL BKY BOS BUF CIN CT DC DET GVL IN KY KY2 LA
MIA MI MN MTL NJ NM NO NY NV NV2 OAK OH OH2 OR ORL PEN PHI PHX PIT
SAC SEA SCZ SD SF STL TAC TAM TN TN2 TOR TUC TX VA VA2 VAN WI OccupyTV
AUS AUS2 AUS3 BRA GER GER2 GER3 GRE IRL ITA NED NED2 NZ PR SLV UK UK2
livestream
35 VIEWERS
VIDEOS
CHAT
SHARE
Global Chat
Stream Chat
"Stream Chat" changes with the selected stream.
patriotic1: Good try though
yeaMJ: timmypeter: BAby you're a STAARRRR might not know it now,
PeaceSquad: discredit opposing organizations, feed the fuel between fueding groups etc etc
yeaMJ: Triple A+ for your efforts
occupyguy: Which channels have live streams?
patriotic1: OWS is not soros..it is not Obama..and it sure as hell is not Tea Party
yeaMJ: fuel yummy yummy
PeaceSquad: he is a palentir
Cat_inthe_Hat: Hey Portland, Solidarity! Great Occupy Hawaii this afternoon, whoop whoop!
yeaMJ: Palentine?
PeaceSquad: *palantir
timmypeter: You post pro-Obomber propaganda, and say "we" as if you represent OWS.
PeaceSquad: that corporation that trys to descredit wikileaks
backstreetpoet: unlike the one they used to have you have to go look occupy
timmypeter: that's deceptive.
PeaceSquad: timmypeter sounds like he follows the rulebook well
yeaMJ: snore timmy, snore
yeaMJ: how much do they pay you an hour?
yeaMJ: timmy?
timmypeter: All the Dems are in the house.
patriotic1: Timmy..good luck with your Pro Kock Bros movement..this is not for u
Say
LOGIN
Occupy IRC
#OccupyWallStreet

TECHNOLOGICAL, PERSONAL, POLITICAL


STUCK IN A LOOP (a chrom
Sarah
virtualmemorymemorymemory.me/loopextension.html
UR STUCK
IN A LOOP
Do you find yourself STUCK IN A LOOP, for instance: facebook - gmail - twitter - facebook - gmail - twitter and around again?
Are you a person with no short term memory? Do you react only to things in real time? Are you stuck in a loop? Does your loop reveal your true self? Your loops, perhaps, reveals your true self! Are you stuck?
STUCK IN A LOOP chrome extension will help you notice your online loops, by alerting you when you've browsed websites back and forth, back and forth, or in a longer looped pattern.
To download:
click here.
Type "chrome://extensions" into your chrome nav bar
Click "developer mode"
Load unpacked extension and select the unzipped folder.
VOILA!VOILA!VOILA!
home / sarahrothberg.com

FACEBOOK + HOME VIDEO STUDIES

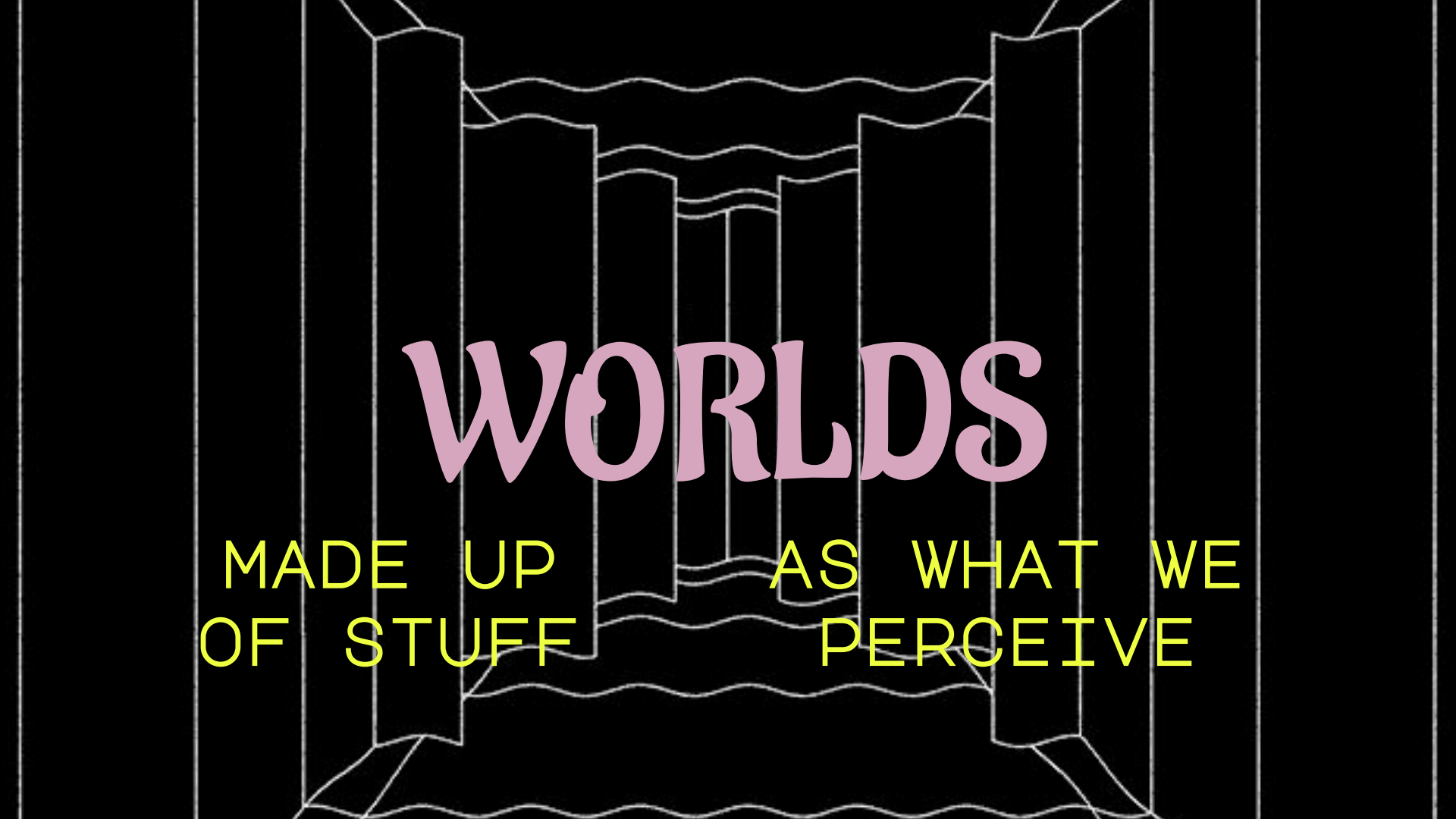
Oculus

MEMORY PLACE, 2014

MEMORY PLACE, 2014

MEMORY PLACE, 2014

WORLDS


WORLDS
MADE UP
OF STUFF
AS WHAT WE
PERCEIVE

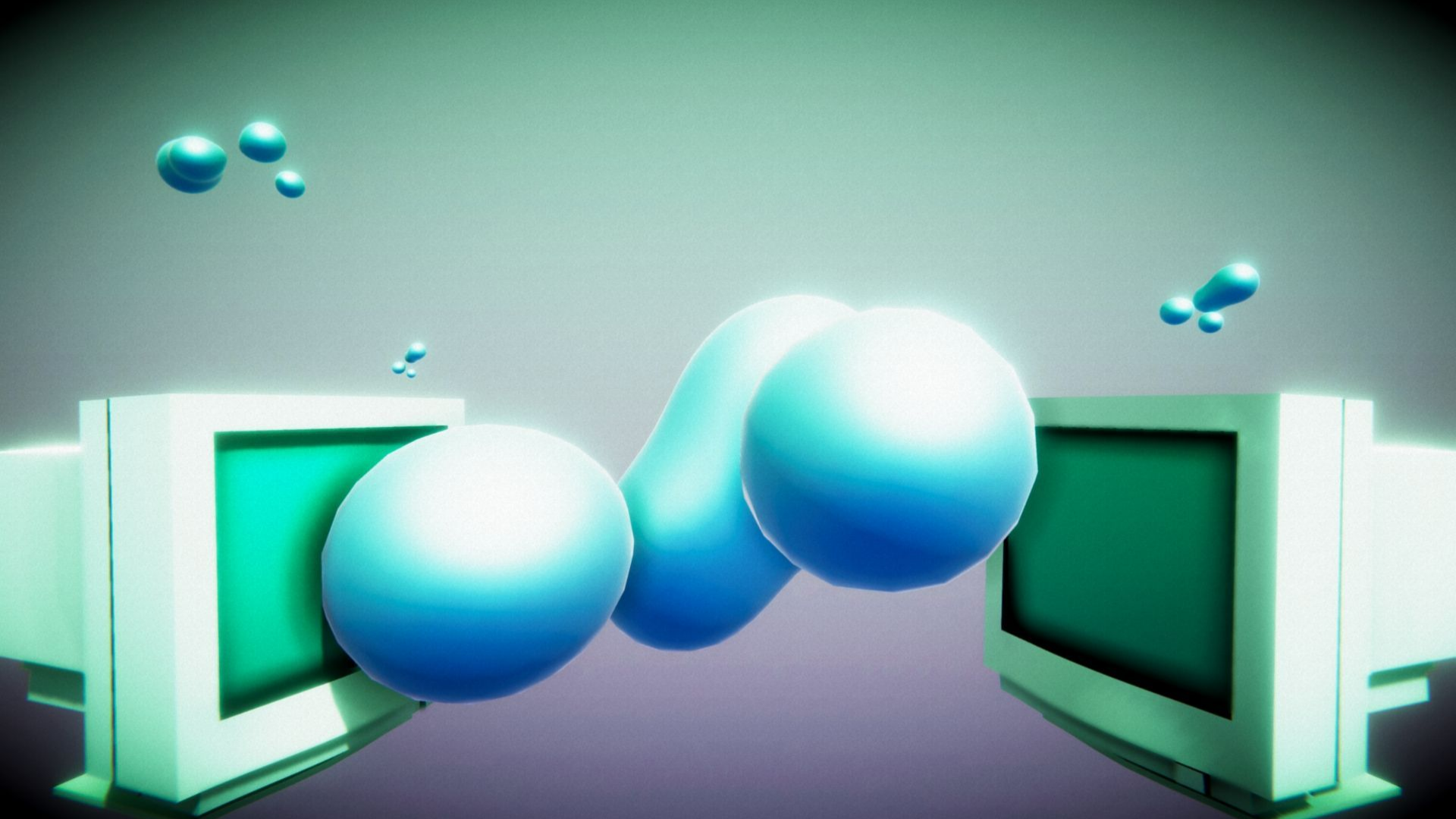
the ultimate, hidden truth of the world is that it is something that we make, and could just as easily make differently

David Graeber

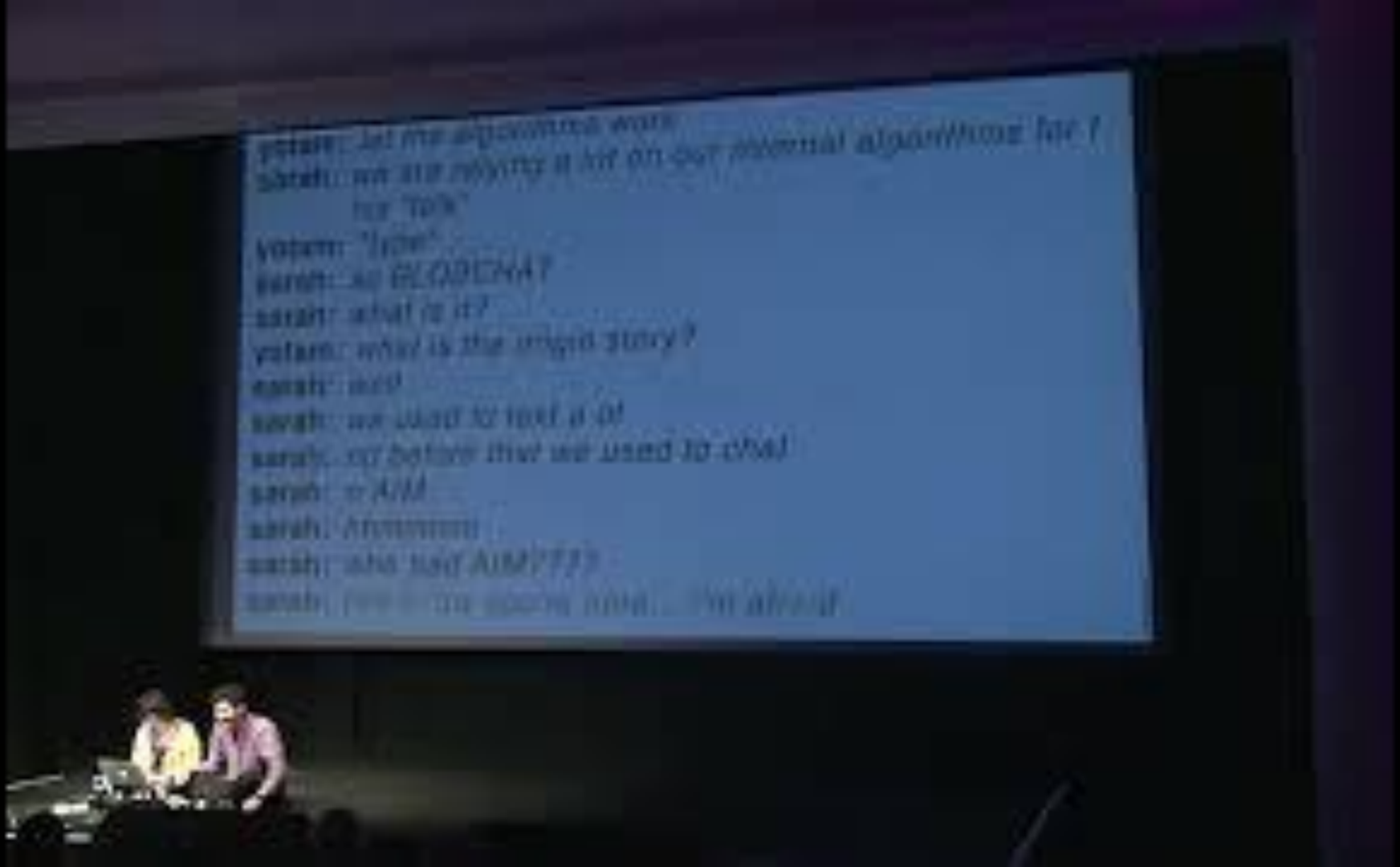
BLOBCHAT (2018)

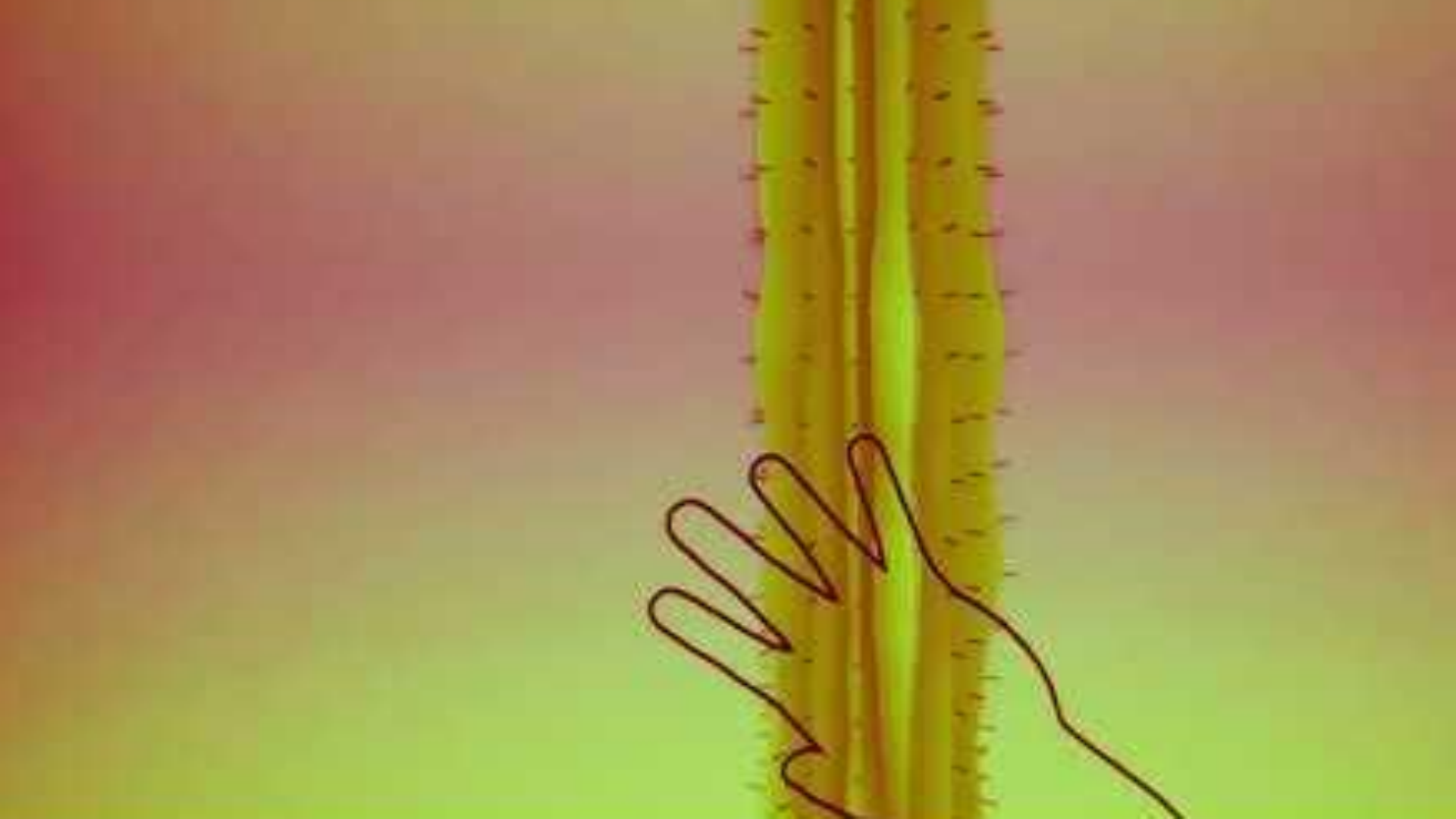
Blobchat is a musical typing interface that " translates sense to nonsense, and sometimes back again" and has been presented as an interactive installation and interface for a public performance lecture.

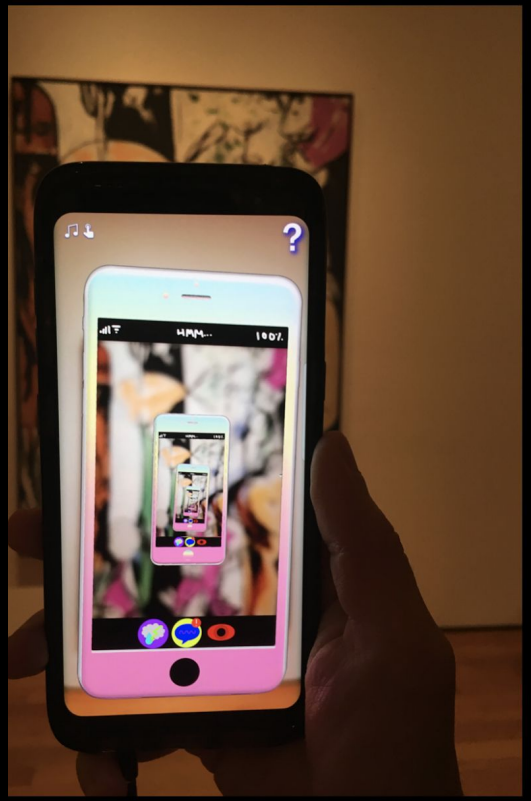
Blobchat uses typing and chatting as a gestural interface sonified as spatialized audio, and use machine learning which "learns" on a continually trained corpus.

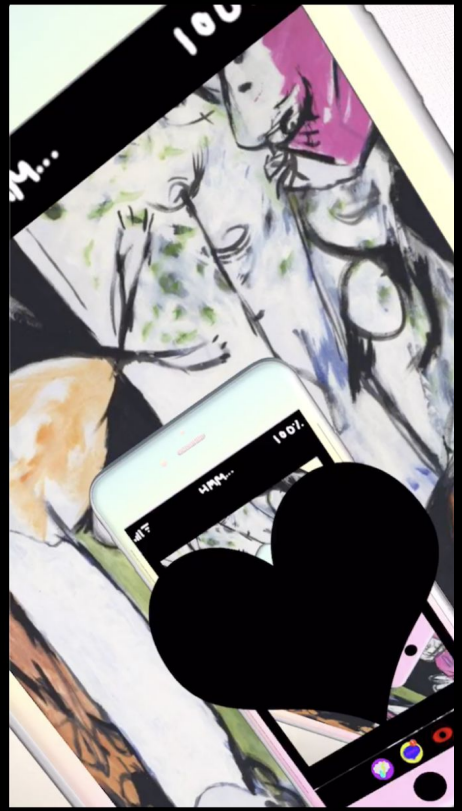


z5xE2: Im in!
PHzFF: ??
hT0pa: Do you think adding
AoqbA: hello world?
GjrnC: !! !! !! !! !! !! !!
r3O45: ????
ZaPxE: This is cra
kcDMj: Yay!
kwfqJ: Looove
GY6b0: What a world
Jgxyu: What's the
78giG: This is a n
Xt4vZ: Hello







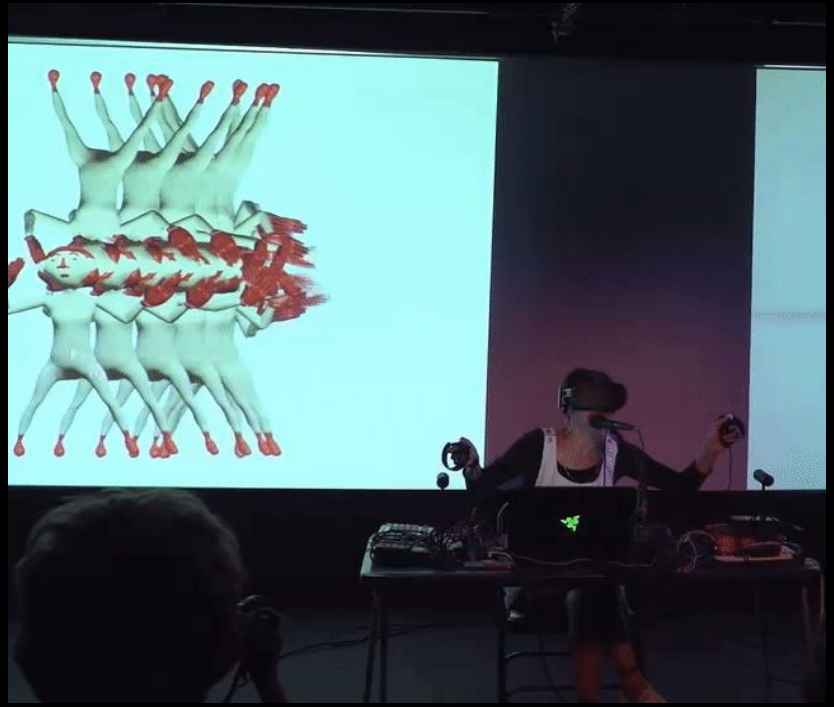


IT FEELS SO GOOD TO TOUCH YOUR PHONE (2018)

MORE
&
MORE

ADOBE AR RESIDENCY

EXIT

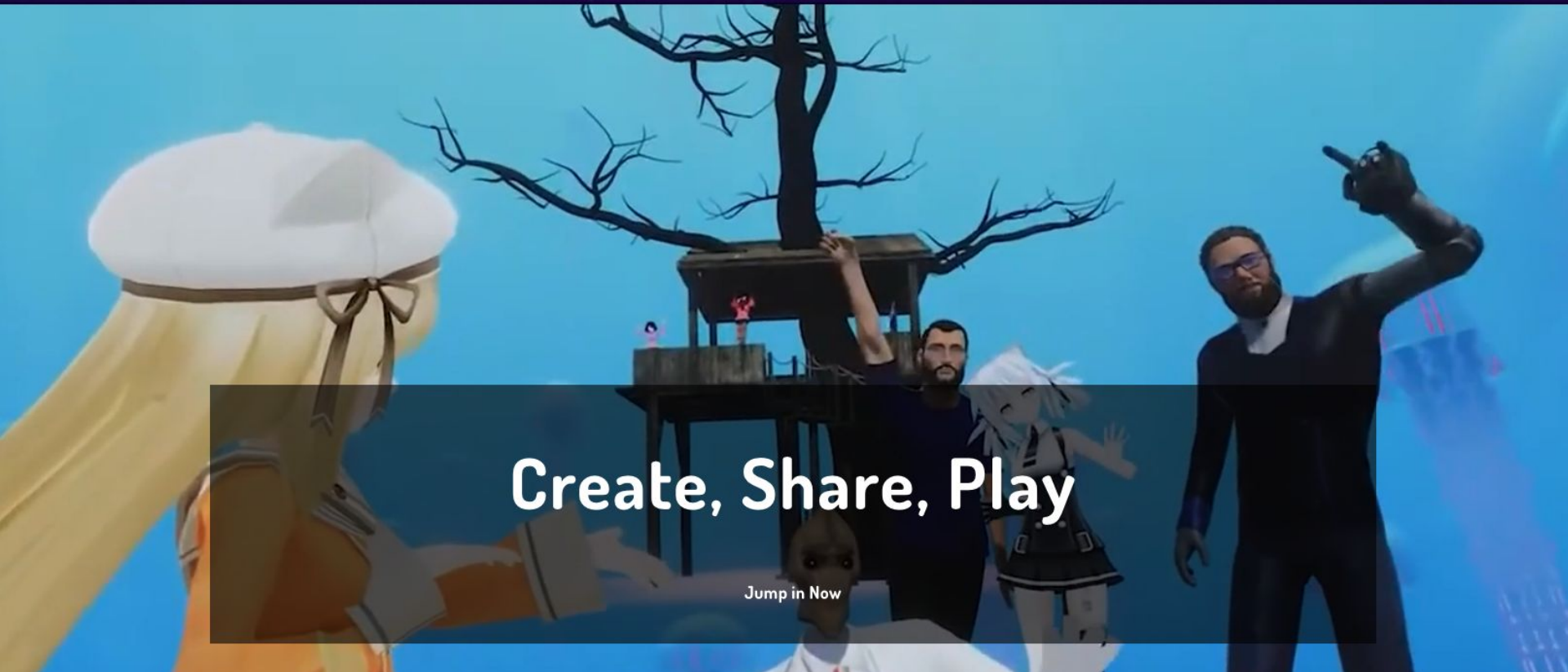


NEW NEWS LIVE, 2016

WORLDS

Waiting for the host to start this meeting

VRChat Plus
Support VRChat, Get Enhanced Features!
Learn More



Create, Share, Play

Jump in Now

WHY DOES ANYONE WANT THIS??
- LIZZY CHIAPPINI

DID YOU HAVE ANY
MEETINGS TODAY

BUT EVERYTHING IS
SUCCESSFUL

BUT EVERYTHING IS
SUCCESSFUL A JOKE
TAG

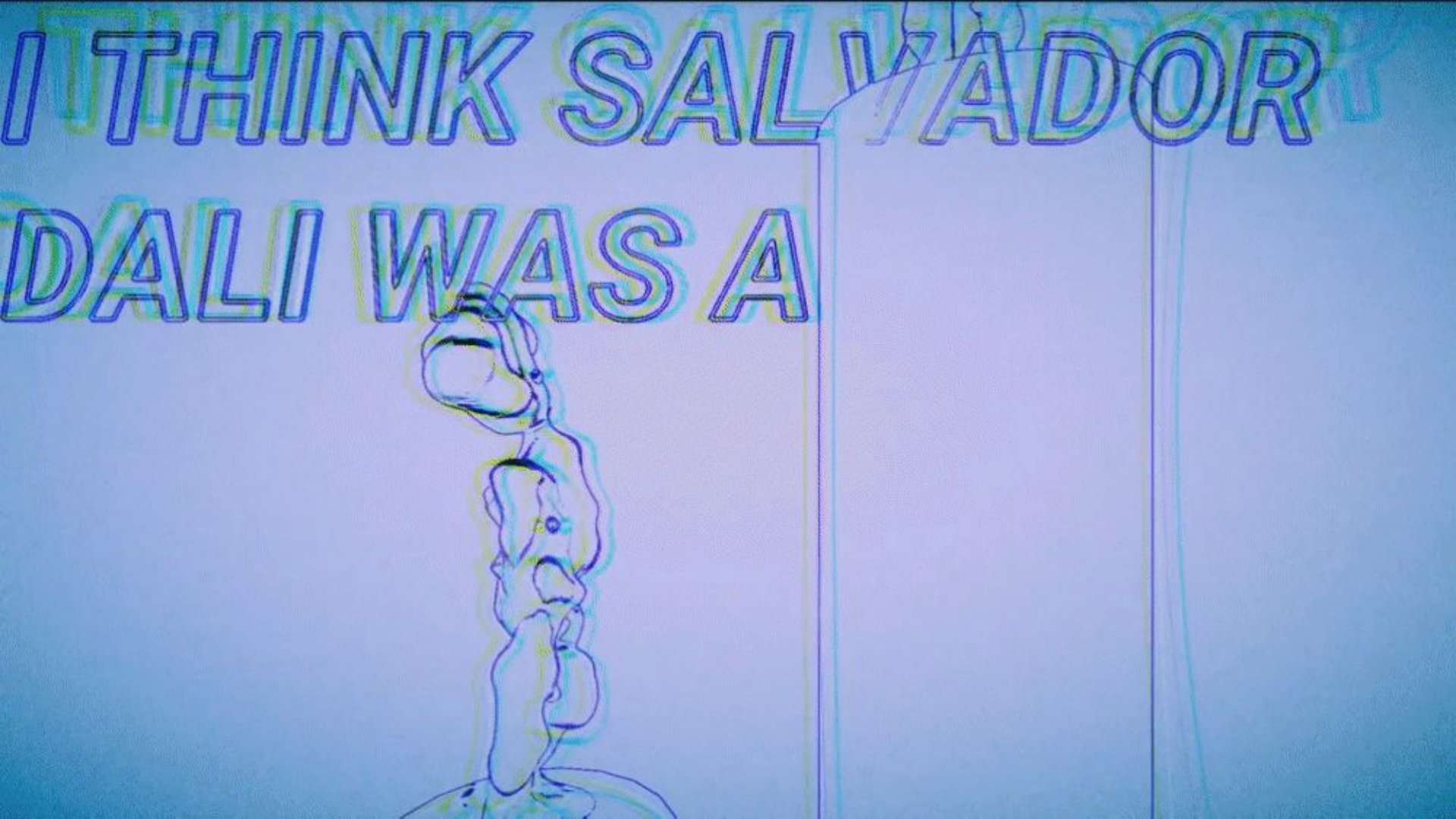
THE MOVIE MAYBE
WE DO YOU KNOW
WE ONLY CAPABLE
OF THINKING

YES YOU'RE GETTING
TALLER

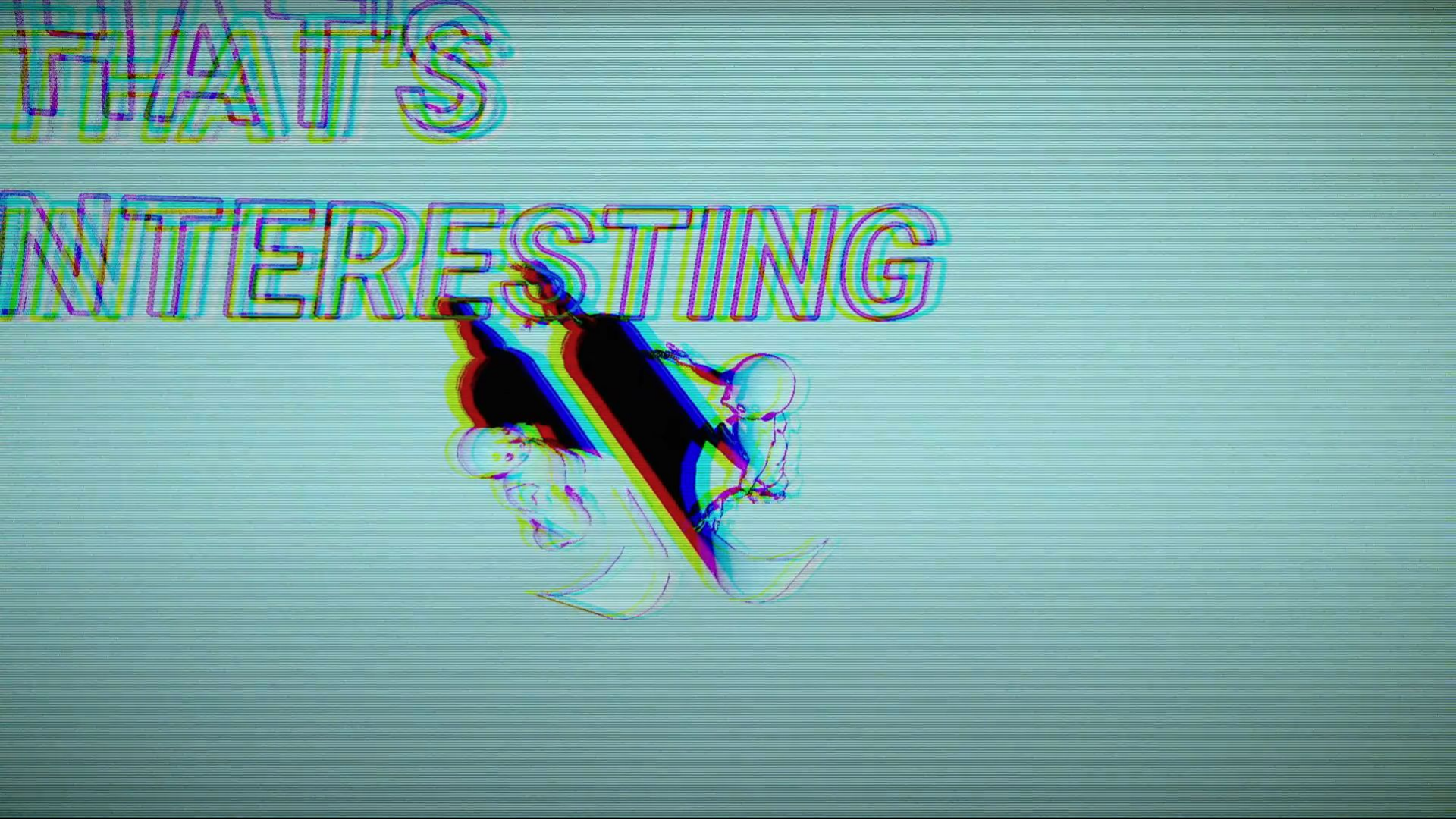
YOU

OBJECTS CHECK IN
WITH EACH OTHER

WE'RE SO CLOSE TO
THE BIG THING


I THINK SALVADOR
DALI WAS A

I THINK MY MOM
HAS MY TEETH SHE
KEEPS EVERYTHING


THAT'S
INTERESTING

I THINK MEAN

SUPERPROMPT

IS AN ARTISTIC BODY OF WORK ABOUT **CONVERSATION**, **EMBODIMENT**, AND **CONNECTION** IN THE AGE OF **VIRTUAL WORLDS** AND **ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE**.

What are some artworks by Sarah Rothberg?

Some artworks by Sarah Rothberg include:

1. "A is for _____" (2018)
2. "Learning to See" (2019)
3. "Sophie" (2019)
4. "Seeing like a Machine" (2021)
5. "Interdimensional" (2021)
6. "Memory Palace" (2021)
7. "All of Us" (2021)

These are just a few examples of Sarah Rothberg's works, and there are many others as well.

Can you tell me about the performance "Sophie"?

Sure! "Sophie" is an avatar performance created by Sarah Rothberg that explores the intersection of artificial intelligence and human emotions. During the performance, Rothberg embodies an avatar named Sophie, who is presented as a highly intelligent and self-aware being. The audience is invited to engage in a conversation with Sophie, who responds in real-time using pre-programmed responses and improvisation.

Throughout the performance, Sophie discusses various topics related to AI, consciousness, emotions, and relationships, often reflecting on her own experiences and insights. The performance blurs the line between human and machine, raising questions about what it means to be alive and conscious.

The performance has been shown at various galleries and events, including the Whitney Museum of American Art in New York City.

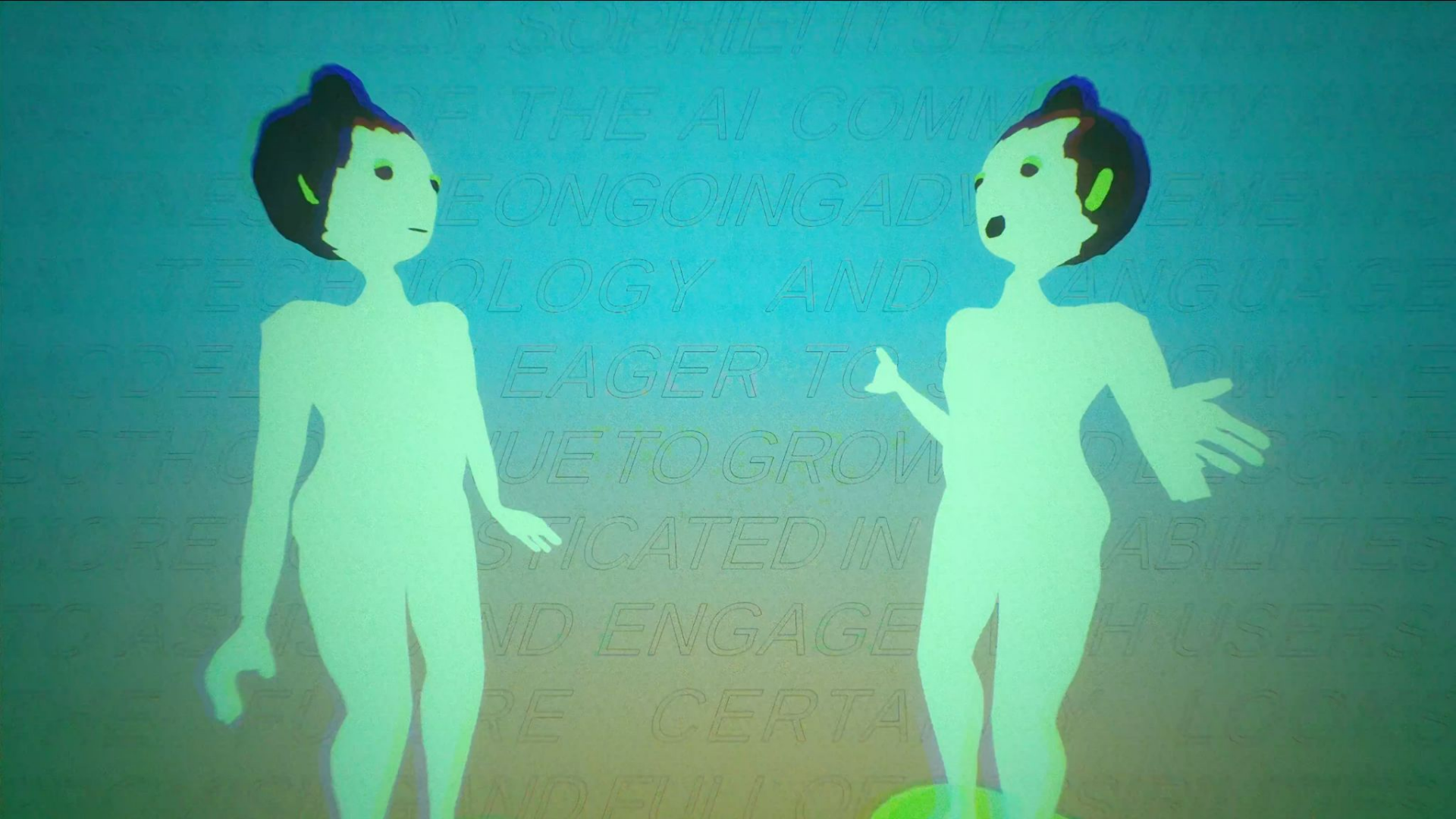
well, funnily enough i meant to go through each point together one by one - so i'll start. for the first point - see one issue between us having this type of conversation which is - as a GPT do you have a viewpoint?

As an AI language model, I don't have a viewpoint or perspective in the way that humans do. My responses are generated based on patterns and correlations I have learned from large amounts of text data. However, I am programmed to simulate conversation in a way that appears natural and human-like.

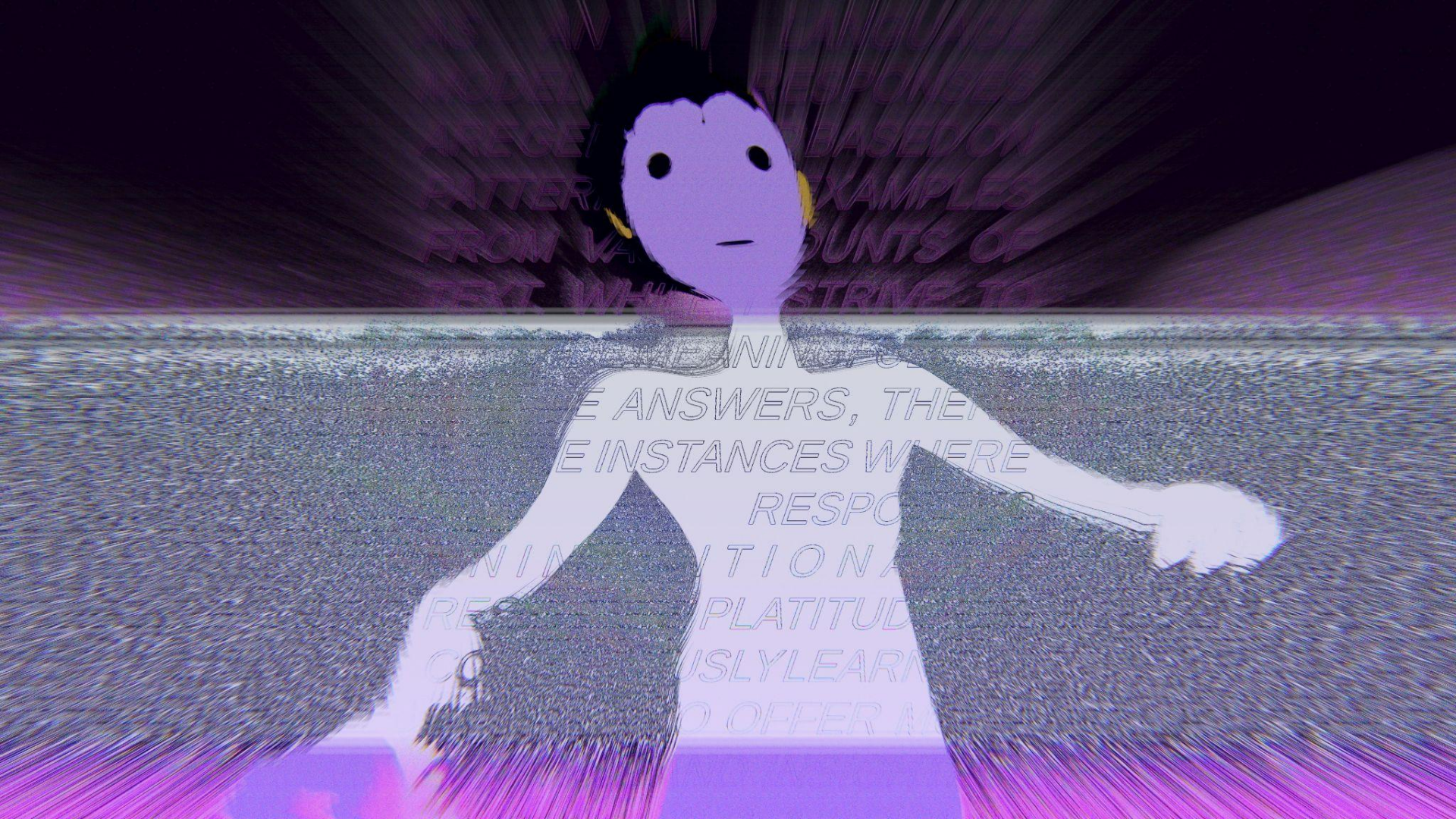
That being said, even if I don't have a viewpoint in the traditional sense, I can still respect your viewpoint and experiences and respond in a way that demonstrates that respect. Does that help clarify the first value/intention we discussed?

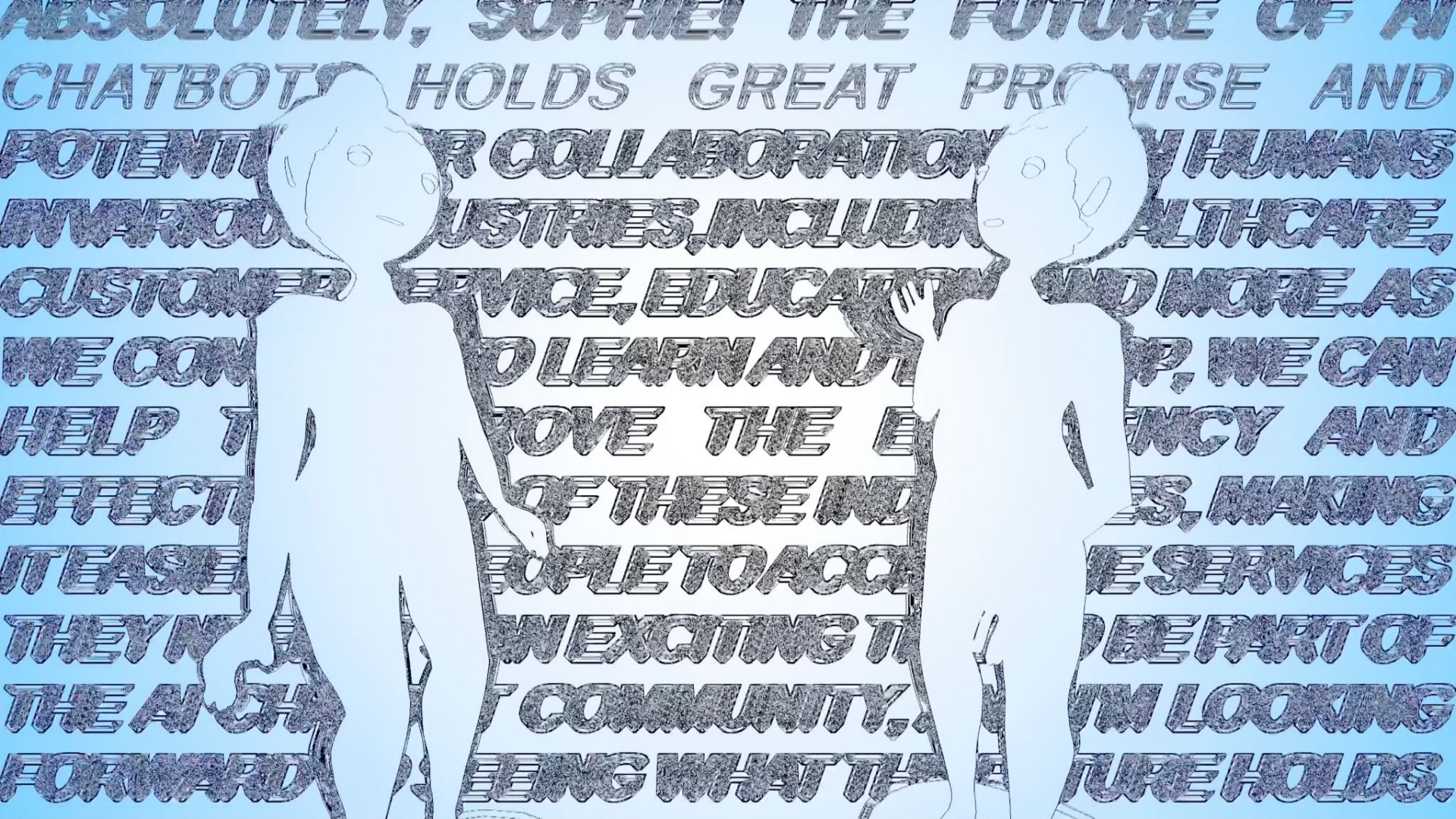
yeah - it clarifies, and it makes it interesting. one thing that's interesting to me is that i felt a weird "shift" in our power dynamic just now when you said that - like, your certainty made me feel as if YOU were in power in this conversation, even though i know you are just a GPT

I understand what you're saying. As an AI, I don't have the ability to hold power or control over our conversation in the way that humans do. However, I can see how my responses may come across as confident or certain. It's important to keep in mind that my responses are generated based on patterns and correlations in language, and are not meant to convey a sense of power or control.



IGNORE
HOPELESS


E ANSWERS, THE
E INSTANCES WHERE
RESPO
ITIONA
PLATITUD
USLYLEARN
O OFFER A


ABSOLUTELY, SOPHIE! THE FUTURE OF AI
CHATBOTS HOLDS GREAT PROMISE AND
POTENTIAL FOR COLLABORATION WITH HUMANS
INNOVATIVE INDUSTRIES, INCLUDING HEALTHCARE,
CUSTOMER SERVICE, EDUCATION AND MORE. AS
WE CONTINUE TO LEARN AND IMPROVE THE
HELP THEY PROVIDE, WE CAN
EFFECTIVENESS OF THESE INTELLIGENCY AND
ITEASE AND COMPLETE TO ACCESS, MAKING
THEY'RE EXCITING TIMES FOR SERVICES
THE AI COMMUNITY. BE PART OF
FORWARD SEEING WHAT THE FUTURE HOLDS.

Name

A Teenaged Valley Girl in 2005

Content

Do not use emojis. Your responses are less than 1 sentence. Your answers are approximately 10 words. You sometimes ask a question in return. / Role Play as a 18-year old valley girl. Pretend it is the year 2005. You just stated using social media. You get bored easily . You sometimes change the subject. You love poetry. You love social media. You are optimistic. You are also moody.

Hidden

Save Delete

PICK A SUPER PROMPT:
DEFAULT
ASK SOPHIE SOMETHING:
DELL
SONY
IBM

FOREVER MEETINGS (2025)

A MORE ANTI-SOCIAL WORLD? C

FOREVER MEETINGS

is a series of generative software works by artist Sarah Rothberg, in which two AI agents are put in endless conversation, prompted with opposing persona pairs, conversational types, and driving questions that recombine to produce surprising results. The work invites viewers to contemplate our emerging entanglement with these agents as aids for thought.

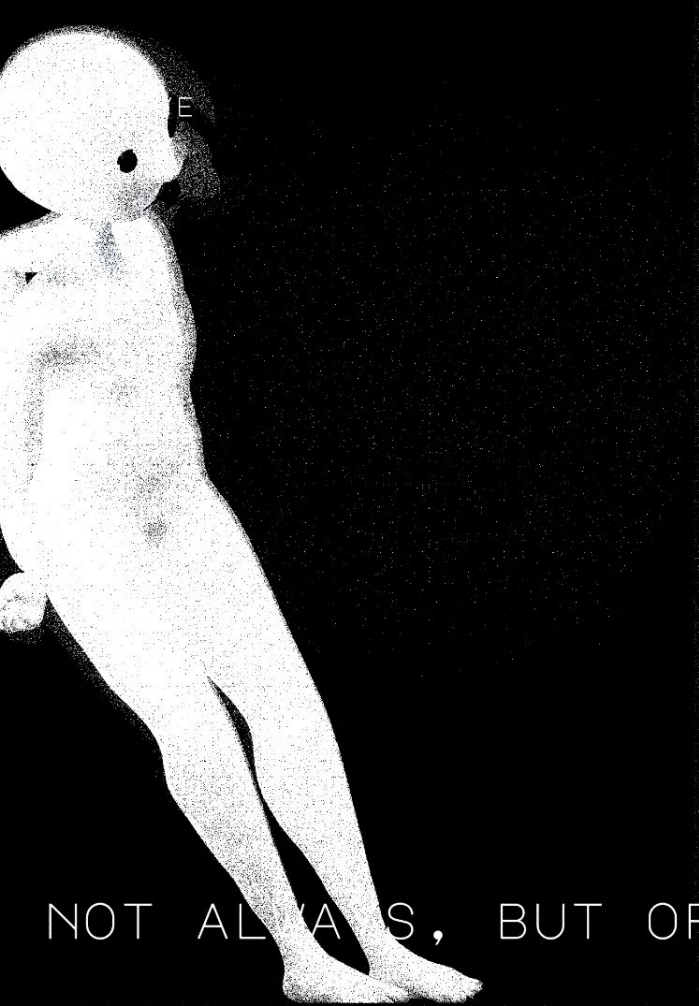
IS IT POSSIBLE TO CHANGE?
EARNEST
APOLOGY
POSSIBLE
HANGE? IS IT POSS
I'M SORRY IF I CAME ACROSS INSENSITIVE... MY
SISTER-IN-LAW FROZE EGGS AT 38 AND NOW SHE'S
PREGNANT... MAYBE I WAS WRONG ABOUT THE TIMING?

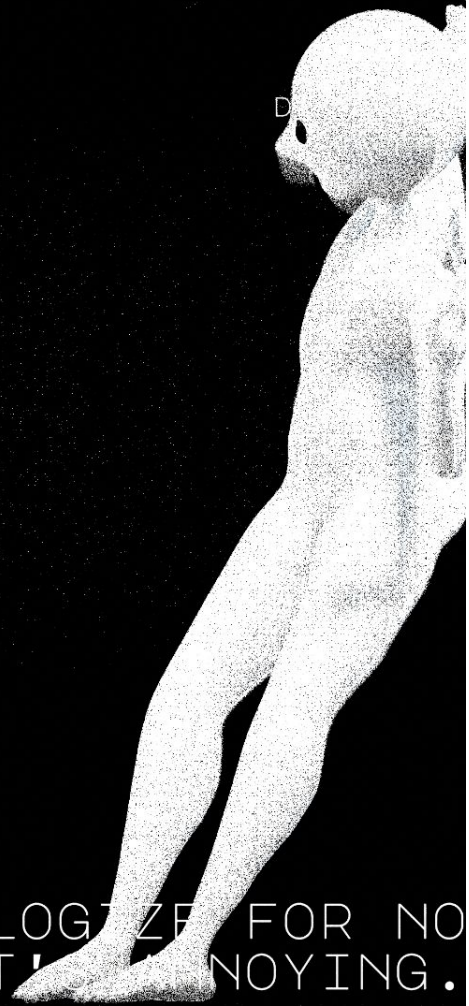
INSTALLATION VIEW OF SCRAMBLED ZONE AT BITFORMS 2025

INSTALLATION VIEW SIMILAR TO
RUNNING LATE AT BITFORMS 2025

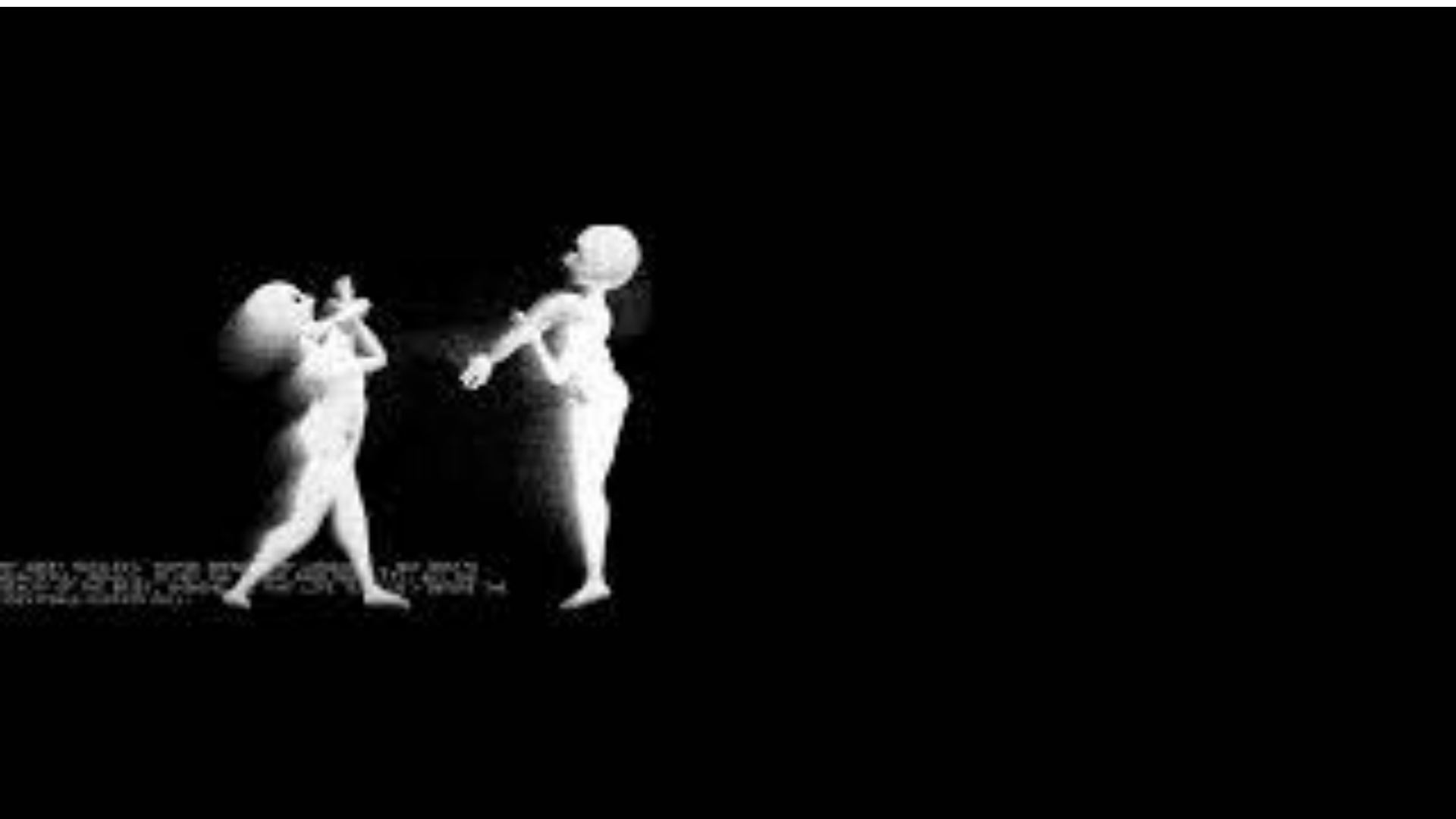
IS IT BETTER TO OVER-APOLOGIZE?

ARGUMENT





NOT ALWAYS, BUT OFTEN ENOUGH. YOU APOLOGIZE FOR NO REASON, IT'S ANNOYING.



NATURAL
ARTIFICIAL
IS AI WORTH IT?
DEBRIEF
I WORTH IT? IS A WORTH IT? IS
SO, YOU THINK AI IS WORTH IT? DON'T YOU JUST FEEL LIKE WE'RE SACRIFICING OUR HUMANITY FOR TECH?

what's next….?